Active Directory User Management Lab

Project Summary

Built an Active Directory user management lab in Windows Server to perform common Tier 1 help desk account tasks, including user creation, property updates, group assignment, and password reset..

Skills Demonstrated

Active Directory user administration, account provisioning, password reset, account review, group membership management, Windows Server support, technical documentation

Objective

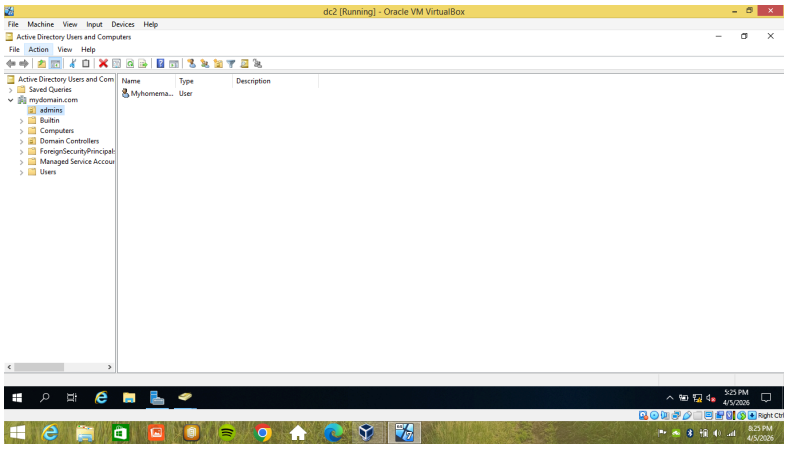
Demonstrate common Tier 1 help desk account management tasks in Active Directory by creating a new user, updating account properties, assigning group membership, and resetting a password.

Tools Used

Windows Server, Server Manager, Active Directory Users and Computers, User Properties, Group Membership, Account Management

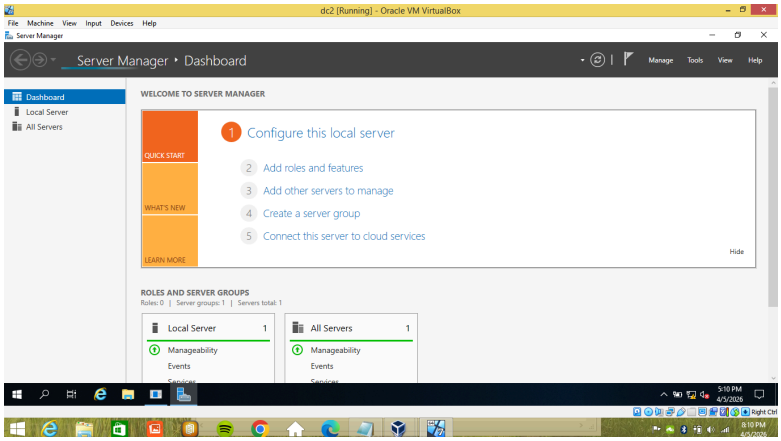
Environment Setup

One Windows Server virtual machine configured with Active Directory tools to simulate common help desk user-account administration tasks.



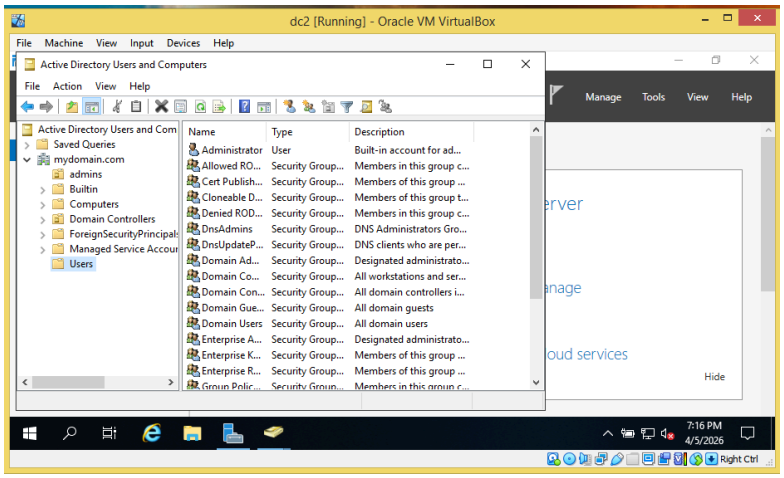
Environment Proof: Windows Server Management Environment

Server Manager was used to verify the Windows Server lab environment before beginning Active Directory user-management tasks.



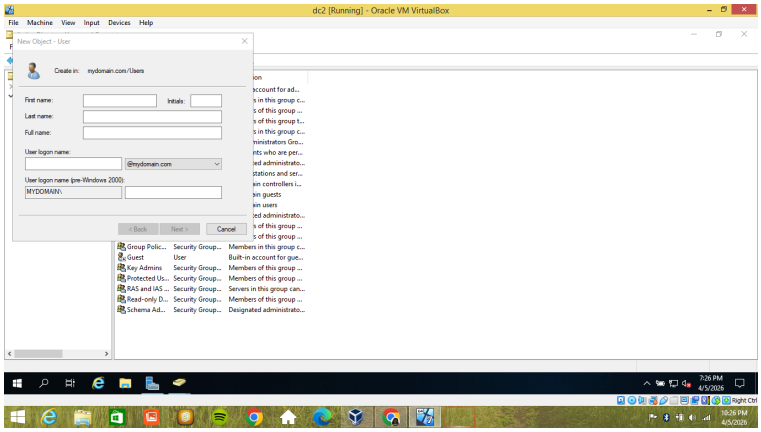
Evidence 1: Active Directory Environment Open

Active Directory Users and Computers was successfully opened on the Windows Server virtual machine, confirming that the account-management environment was available for help desk user administration tasks.



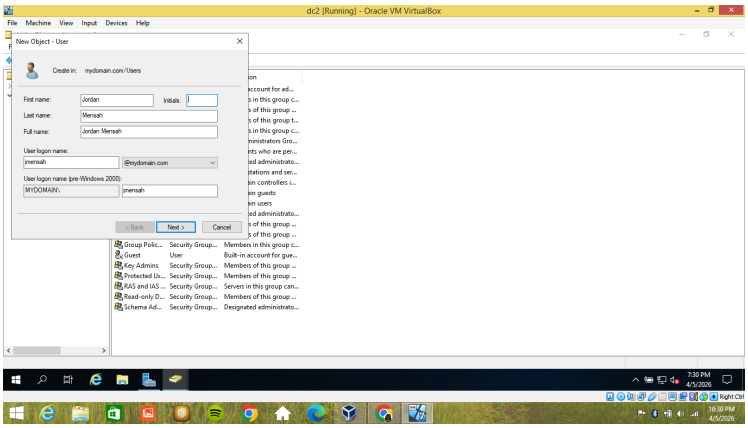
Evidence 2: New User Creation Initiated

A new user account creation process was initiated in Active Directory Users and Computers to simulate a standard Tier 1 help desk account-provisioning request.



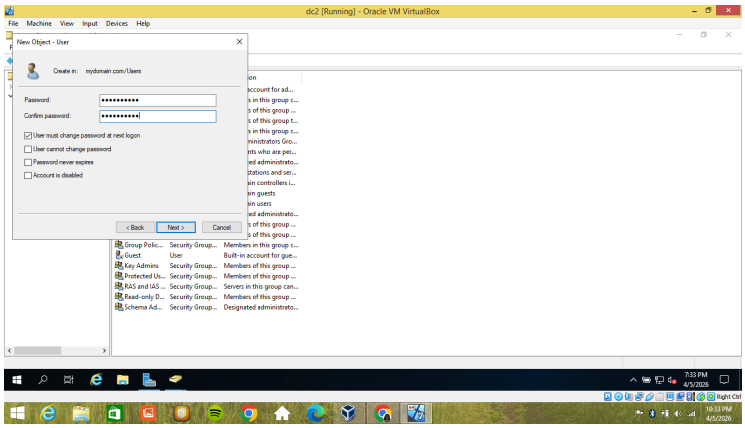
Evidence 3: New User Details Entered

Realistic employee details were entered into the new user form, including first name, last name, full name, and logon name.



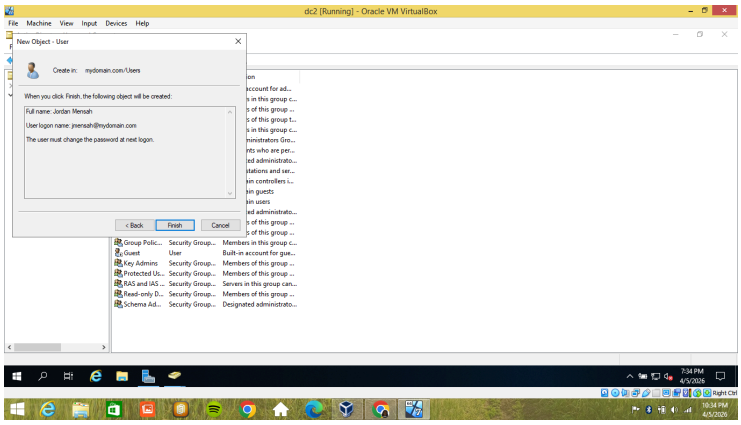
Evidence 4: Initial Password Configuration

An initial account password was configured for the new user, and the option requiring a password change at next logon was selected as part of standard account setup.



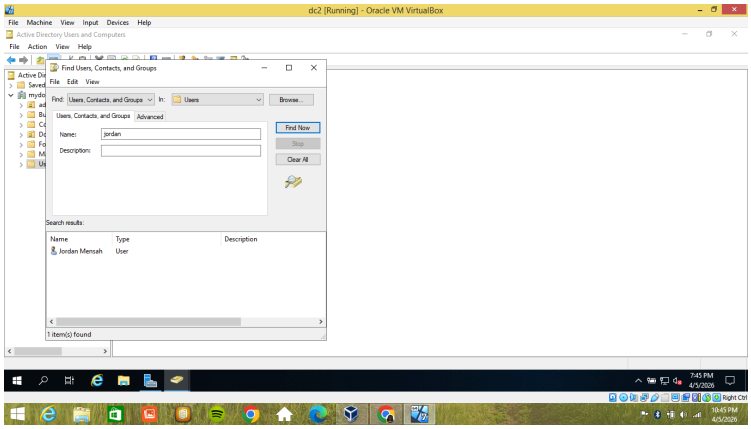
Evidence 5: User Creation Review Before Completion

The account creation summary was reviewed before completion to confirm the user details and password policy settings were correct.



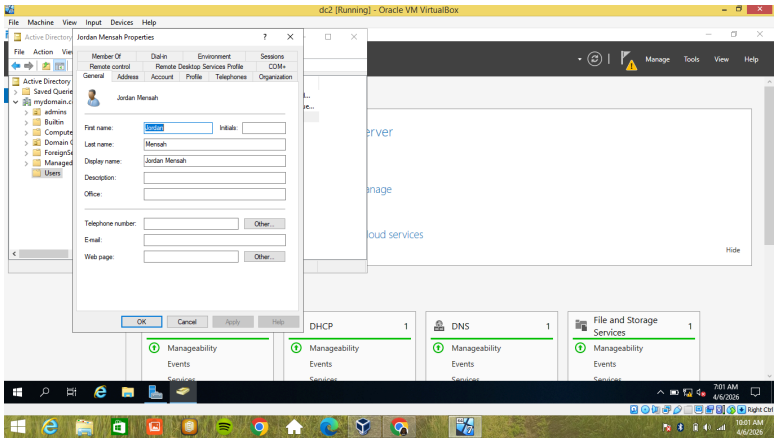
Evidence 6: New User Account Verified

The newly created user account was verified in Active Directory, confirming that the account provisioning task was completed successfully.



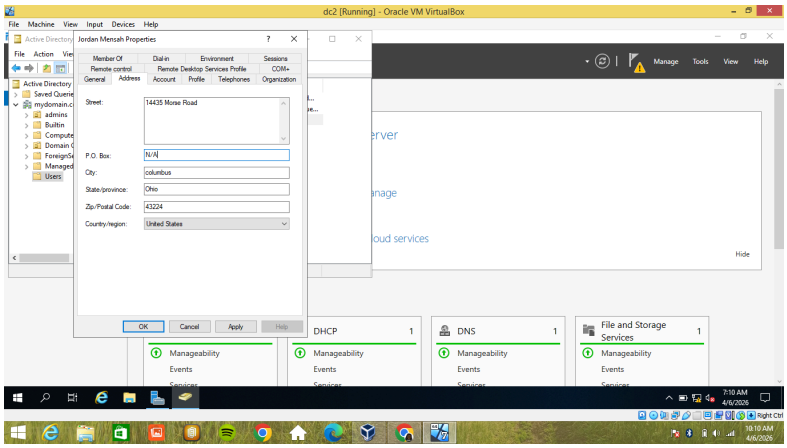
Evidence 7: User Properties Updated

The user properties window was opened to review and update business-related account details for the newly created employee account.



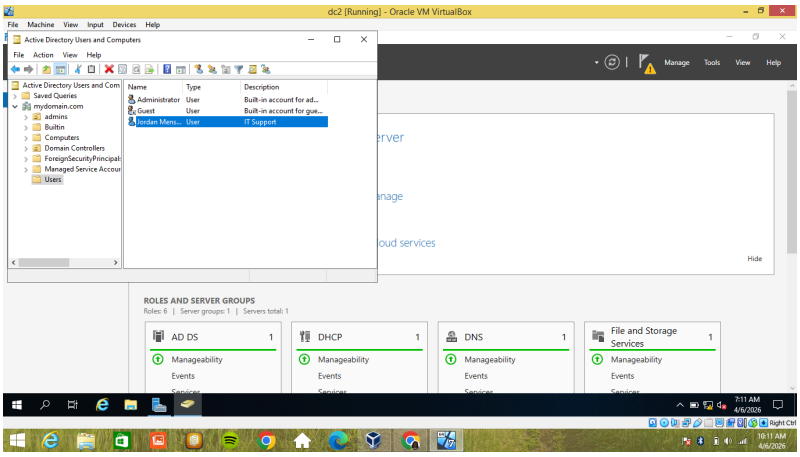
Evidence 8: User Address Information Updated

Business-related address information was added to the new user account to simulate realistic employee record management in Active Directory.



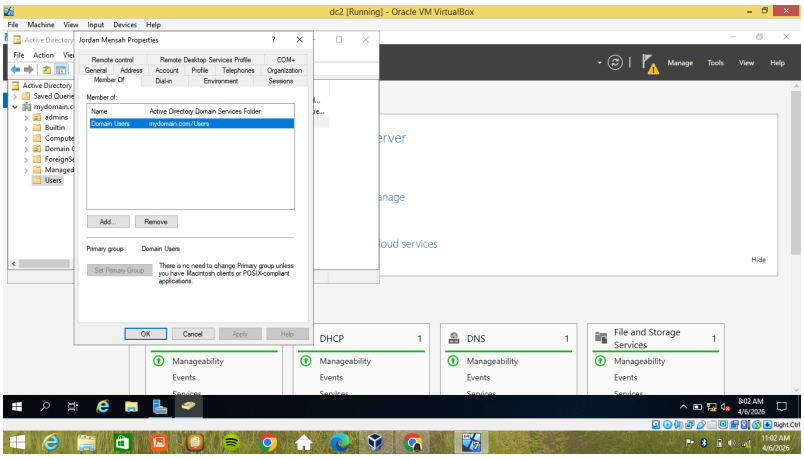
Evidence 9: User Description / Department Verified

The newly created account was reviewed in the Active Directory Users and Computers list view, confirming that the user record was updated and labeled for IT Support.



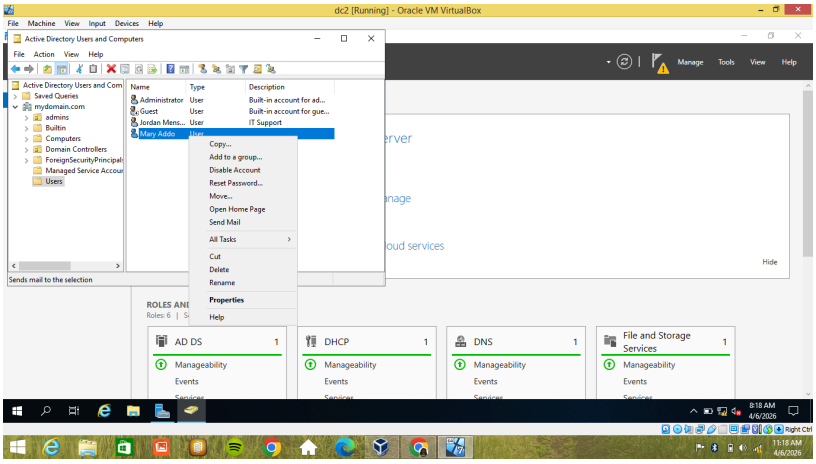
Evidence 10: Group Membership Assignment

The new user account was reviewed for group membership and assigned to the appropriate group to support role-based access management.



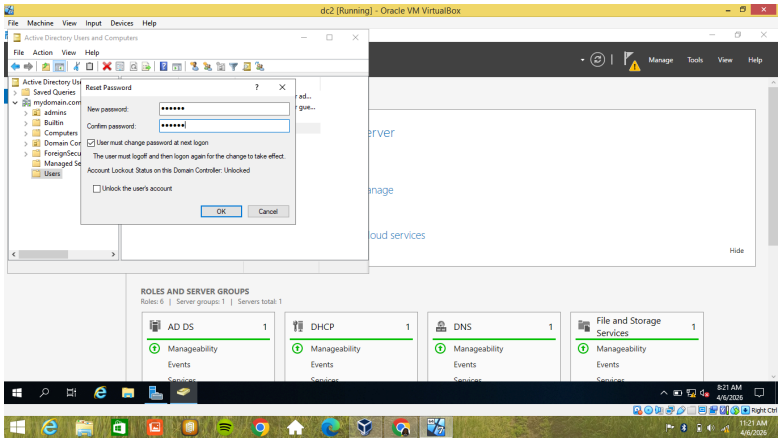
Evidence 11: Password Reset Initiated

A password reset action was initiated for an existing user account as part of a standard Tier 1 help desk account-support request.



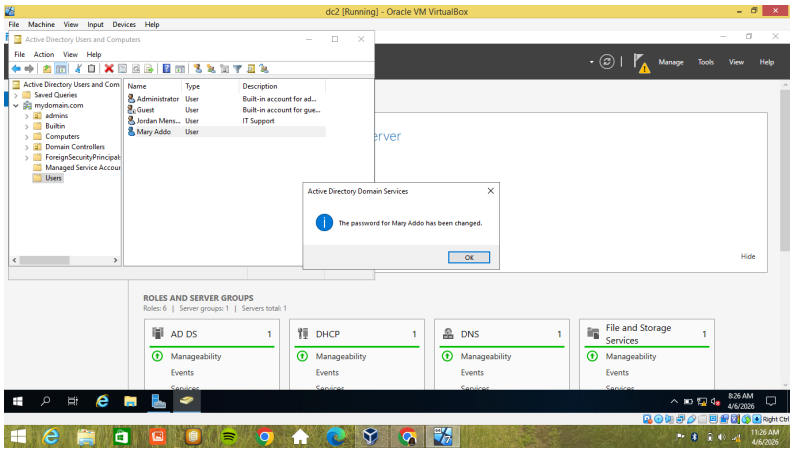
Evidence 12: Password Reset Performed

A new password was entered for the selected user account, and the standard password-reset process was completed through Active Directory Users and Computers.



Evidence 13: Password Reset Confirmation

Active Directory confirmed that the password reset for the selected user account was completed successfully.



Steps Taken

1. Verified the Windows Server environment and opened Active Directory Users and Computers.
2. Reviewed the Active Directory environment and initiated a new user-creation process in the Users container.
3. Entered realistic employee details for the new account.
4. Configured the initial password and reviewed the user-creation summary before completion.
5. Verified the new account in Active Directory after creation.
6. Opened the user properties window and reviewed business-related account details.
7. Updated address and account-description information for the new user.
8. Reviewed group membership for the new account and confirmed assignment to Domain Users.

9. Selected an existing user account and initiated a password reset.
10. Entered a new password and completed the reset process.
11. Verified that Active Directory confirmed the password change successfully.

Resolution / Outcome

The lab demonstrated successful completion of common Active Directory help desk tasks, including user creation, initial password setup, account verification, user-property updates, address updates, group membership review, password reset initiation, password reset completion, and successful confirmation of the password change.

What I Learned

I learned how to perform core Tier 1 help desk account-management tasks in Active Directory, including provisioning new users, configuring initial password settings, verifying account creation, updating user properties, reviewing group membership, and resetting passwords for existing users in a Windows Server environment.